



Tips & Tricks



Highlight multiple searches in Vim

Download Multisearch.vim from vim.org. Copy it to your local plugin's directory for Vim and restart Vim.

Use `:Search` and `:SearchReset` commands to get each search highlighted by a different colour. It automatically handles colours from your terminal capabilities.

Enjoy :-)

—Srivatsan, sree.sdrajan@gmail.com



Ye'SS'! That's the way!

A common need for most computer users is to check the ports that are open in a system. The most oft used utility to achieve this is `netstat`, which can be used on both Linux and Windows systems.

The problem that users face with this utility on Linux machines is that the command lists TCP/IP ports first up, which are usually of more interest, followed by UNIX sockets, which are not often needed.

Piping this output to `'less'` or using a switch to the command (`--protocol=inet`) to see only TCP/IP domain sockets involves cumbersome typing work.

Another utility that is not very well known is `-ss` (socket status). This command passes the ability to list only the TCP, UDP socket status of a system.

The following command lists the open TCP sockets in the system:

```
root@jeos#ss -tan
```

Replace the `'t'` with `'u'` and you can list the UDP socket information:

```
root@jeos#ss -uan
```

Of course, this command also provides a host of other options to view socket-related information. Head to the man page now to explore further.

Note: This command is provided by the `'iproute'` package. In your installation, check if it is installed using

the following command:

```
root@jeos#rpm -qa iproute {On Red-Hat and its derivatives}
root@jeos#dpkg -l iproute {On Debian and its derivatives}
```

—Navneet Thillaisthanam, navneet.ts@gmail.com



Open a terminal here!

You can create a menu entry to open a terminal in your current location. Just create a file, say `"Open_Terminal_Here"` (without the quotes), in your `$HOME/.gnome2/nautilus-scripts` directory:

```
$ cat ~/.gnome2/nautilus-scripts/"Open Terminal Here"
```

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
gnome-terminal --working-directory='`pwd`'
```

Now, provide the execution permission for the file:

```
$ chmod +x ~/.gnome2/nautilus-scripts/Open*
```

—Chandan V, cdn.kit@gmail.com



Execute commands while editing files in VI editor without exiting it

While you are editing a file in the VI editor, you can execute certain commands *without exiting it* and look at the output of the command as well.

You can do this inside the editor by typing the following:

```
!:command-name
```

...in the command mode, just like you would save and exit the editor. This will display the output of the command. You can return to editing the file by just pressing the `Enter` key.

—Bhuvanesh Kumar, bhuvibhuvanesh@gmail.com